



R.E.L. Musik (Germany)



Tilting the Balance

R.E.L. Musik Supplies JBL HLA System for Germany's "Modern Talking" Tour

May, 1999 - Modern Talking, fronted by a pair of singer-songwriters who racked up an impressive string of hit singles during the 1980's, is back in the public eye. The popular music group's current European tour is being supported by R.E.L. Musik GmbH of Steinhagen, Germany. Modern Talking has been selling out shows this spring in Germany's major venues. Typical was a recent show at Gerry Weber Stadion, an 8,000-seat indoor arena in the city of Halle that has recently hosted shows with international artists like Rod Stewart, Julio Iglesias, Whitney Houston, Elton John and Scorpions. Modern Talking's 5-truck tour is carrying full stage, lighting and sound production. Audio rental vendor R.E.L. Musik is supplying a JBL HLA (Horn Loaded Array) system, powered by Crest amplifiers. Model 9001, 8001 and 7001 dual-channel amps are in use.

Monitor mixer Andy Ebert operates a Soundcraft SM-16 console. R.E.L. Musik supplies Shure's UHF in-ear monitoring system for a number of the musicians onstage with Modern Talking. Crown VZ5000, MA2400 and MA1200 amplifiers power the monitor system's onstage sidefills and wedges.

The tour is carrying a total of 36 JBL HLA 4895 3-way and 20 JBL HLA 4897 bass modules, fully equipped with ATM Flyware for being assembled into large hanging arrays. "With this tour setup, we can do up to 7 hanging columns per side," advises owner Klaus Rahe, who has been the front-of-house soundmixer for Modern Talking since the group's early shows in nightclubs nearly fifteen years ago.

"The HLA system rigs quite easily. It is one of the most simple, elegant hardware systems I have seen for hanging loudspeaker arrays," notes Rahe. "Here at Gerry Weber Stadion, there is a weight restriction on the soft roof, so we are only using two chain motor per side. Here, we're stacking the HLA units 3 high, with smaller 2-deep flying arrays to support the upper seating areas. We'll normally hang most of the sound system. For very large venues, like our recent Berlin show where we set up a 60+40 HLA rig, we supplement the P.A. with additional units."

Rahe mixes Modern Talking on a Midas XL200 console, and relies on XTAGQ600 dual-channel graphic equalizers. The front-of-house drive equipment also includes an XTA RT-1 analyzer, BSS Varicurve FCS-926 digital e.q.'s, and Omnidrive FDS388 system controllers. Each show is like a list of "Top Ten" hit singles, as Modern

Talking moves through an upbeat, dance-oriented set list that

"This band has a very loyal group of fans," explains Rahe. "They know the words to nearly every song, and oftentimes the huge crowds will sing along very enthusiastically. It can sometimes get to the point that I really appreciate the JBL HLA system's headroom capabilities. As you demand more of the system, HLA keeps on putting out clear, even sound levels without distortion or overloading the components, as happens on many other systems. This is one of JBL's strong features, the ability to provide very high output levels when required, while at the same time retaining a clear, crisp, detailed mix".

R.E.L. Musik was originally formed nearly ten years ago to handle live-event mixing, and specialized console and signal processing rentals on a regional basis. The firm's dedication to audio quality, and ability to satisfy demanding professional acts, has enabled it to expand its operations to a national level, and to grow steadily in the past decade. "We got tired of having to rely on different quality levels of rented speaker systems at every show for our live sound projects," explains Rahe. "We decided to add large-venue speaker system capabilities to ensure we have full control of the sound for the concerts and special events we work on".

Rahe's live sound projects have frequently taken him abroad, and have given him an exposure to a wide variety of rental speaker systems. "Working in different countries, it's always interesting to see how other audio firms handle system setup," he comments. "I've done several projects in Egypt, for example, near the pyramids... large outdoor events like this can be quite challenging. We have worked with a regional company there, Meter, that also has a good-sized JBL HLA system."

R.E.L. Musik GmbH specializes in providing mixing services and complete audio production and rental packages for concerts, festivals and special events that feature live music. The company is located at Stettiner Str, #26, 33803 Steinhagen, Germany. The phone number is +49 52046133.

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